

HEALING TOGETHER

A Faith-Based Journal for Families
Affected by Addiction

Boundaries | Surrender | Self-Care | Hope

Daniel Tesfamariam

For those who love someone struggling with addiction

Healing Together

A Faith-Based Journal for Families Affected by Addiction

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This journal supports but does not replace professional help.

If you are in danger, call 911. SAMHSA helpline: 1-800-662-4357

You did not cause it. You cannot cure it. You cannot control it.

Day 1

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

Trust in the Lord with all thine heart; and lean not unto thine own understanding. - Proverbs 3:5

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 2

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

Cast thy burden upon the Lord, and he shall sustain thee. - Psalm
55:22

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 3

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

Be still, and know that I am God. - Psalm 46:10

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 4

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

Peace I leave with you, my peace I give unto you. Let not your heart
be troubled. - John 14:27

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 5

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

Come unto me, all ye that labour and are heavy laden, and I will
give you rest. - Matthew 11:28

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 6

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

The Lord is my strength and my shield; my heart trusted in him, and
I am helped. - Psalm 28:7

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 7

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

For God hath not given us the spirit of fear; but of power, and of love, and of a sound mind. - 2 Timothy 1:7

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 8

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

And we know that all things work together for good to them that love
God. - Romans 8:28

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 9

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

I can do all things through Christ which strengtheneth me. -
Philippians 4:13

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 10

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

The Lord is nigh unto them that are of a broken heart. - Psalm 34:18

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 11

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

He giveth power to the faint; and to them that have no might he
increaseth strength. - Isaiah 40:29

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 12

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

When thou passest through the waters, I will be with thee. - Isaiah
43:2

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 13

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

Let go, and let God. Commit thy way unto the Lord; trust also in him. - Psalm 37:5

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 14

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

My grace is sufficient for thee: for my strength is made perfect in
weakness. - 2 Corinthians 12:9

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 15

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

Fear thou not; for I am with thee: be not dismayed; for I am thy
God. - Isaiah 41:10

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 16

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

The Lord shall fight for you, and ye shall hold your peace. - Exodus
14:14

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 17

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

Wait on the Lord: be of good courage, and he shall strengthen thine heart. - Psalm 27:14

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 18

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

Casting all your care upon him; for he careth for you. - 1 Peter 5:7

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 19

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

For I know the plans I have for you, declares the Lord, plans for good and not evil. - Jeremiah 29:11

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 20

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

He restoreth my soul: he leadeth me in the paths of righteousness. -
Psalm 23:3

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 21

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

Create in me a clean heart, O God; and renew a right spirit within me. - Psalm 51:10

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 22

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

Blessed is the man that trusteth in the Lord, and whose hope the
Lord is. - Jeremiah 17:7

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 23

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

Be anxious for nothing, but in everything by prayer let your requests be made known. - Philippians 4:6

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 24

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

The Lord is good, a strong hold in the day of trouble. - Nahum 1:7

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 25

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

Weeping may endure for a night, but joy cometh in the morning. -
Psalm 30:5

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 26

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

I will never leave thee, nor forsake thee. - Hebrews 13:5

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 27

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

Be strong and of a good courage; be not afraid, for the Lord thy God
is with thee. - Joshua 1:9

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 28

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

He healeth the broken in heart, and bindeth up their wounds. - Psalm
147:3

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 29

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

The righteous cry, and the Lord heareth, and delivereth them out of
all their troubles. - Psalm 34:17

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

Day 30

Date: _____

Today I choose: ☐ Peace ☐ Boundaries ☐ Self-care

Scripture:

Thou wilt keep him in perfect peace, whose mind is stayed on thee. -
Isaiah 26:3

I release control over:

Boundaries I maintained today:

My feelings are valid:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

I took care of MYSELF by:

I prayed for my loved one:

AI-Anon/Nar-Anon principle I practiced:

Gratitude:

1. _____

2. _____

DETACHMENT WITH LOVE - Exercise 1

WHAT IS DETACHMENT WITH LOVE?

Detachment does NOT mean you stop loving them.
It means you stop letting their addiction control YOUR life.

Detachment IS:

- Allowing them to face consequences of their choices
- Not lying, covering up, or making excuses for them
- Taking care of your own physical and mental health
- Accepting you cannot fix, cure, or control their addiction
- Trusting God with what you cannot control

Detachment is NOT:

- Stopping love or prayer
- Cruelty or punishment
- Giving up hope

Where am I still trying to control their addiction?

What would I do differently if I accepted I am powerless over this?

DETACHMENT WITH LOVE - Exercise 2

THE THREE C's MEDITATION:

I did not CAUSE their addiction.

(Repeat this until you believe it.)

I cannot CURE their addiction.

(No amount of love, nagging, or sacrifice will fix this.)

I cannot CONTROL their addiction.

(Only they can choose recovery.)

What guilt am I carrying that isn't mine?

What have I sacrificed trying to cure them?

What am I trying to control right now?

Lord, I surrender _____ to You.

DETACHMENT WITH LOVE - Exercise 3

LETTING GO OF THE OUTCOME:

You have prayed. You have tried. You have loved.

Now: can you release the outcome to God?

The outcome I am desperate for:

What I'm afraid will happen if I let go:

What is the COST of holding on so tightly?

To my health: _____

To my peace: _____

To my other relationships: _____

To my faith: _____

A prayer of surrender:

'God, I place _____ in Your hands today.

I trust that You love them even more than I do.

Give me the serenity to accept what I cannot change. Amen.'

DETACHMENT WITH LOVE - Exercise 4

BOUNDARIES ARE LOVE:

A boundary is not a wall. It is a statement of what you will and will not accept. Boundaries protect you AND respect them by treating them as capable adults.

Complete these sentences:

I will no longer _____
(enabling behavior I'm stopping)

If _____ happens, I will _____
(consequence I will follow through on)

I need _____ in order to feel safe.

I am allowed to _____
(permission you need to give yourself)

Keeping this boundary is an act of love because:

DETACHMENT WITH LOVE - Exercise 5

FINDING MYSELF AGAIN:

Living with addiction often means losing yourself.

Your entire world revolves around their crisis.

Today, remember: YOU are a person too.

Before addiction took over, I enjoyed:

I used to dream about:

People I've lost touch with:

One thing I will do for MYSELF this week:

I am more than their addiction. I am:

'For I know the plans I have for you,' declares the Lord.

Those plans include YOUR healing, not just theirs.

MY BOUNDARIES LIST

These are my non-negotiable boundaries. I will enforce them with love.

I will NOT:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____

I WILL:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____

If my boundaries are violated, I will:

MY SUPPORT NETWORK

You cannot do this alone. Fill in your support team:

Al-Anon/Nar-Anon meeting:

Day/Time: _____ Location: _____

Sponsor/Mentor:

Phone: _____

Therapist/Counselor:

Phone: _____

Pastor/Faith leader:

Phone: _____

Trusted friend #1:

Phone: _____

Trusted friend #2:

Phone: _____

Family member I can talk to:

Phone: _____

Crisis line:

SAMHSA: 1-800-662-4357

I will reach out to someone when:

LETTER TO MY ADDICTED LOVED ONE

(You don't have to send this. This is for YOUR healing.)

Dear _____,

Lined area for writing the letter.

This image shows a full page of blank, lined paper. It features approximately 20 evenly spaced horizontal grey lines across its entire width, providing a guide for handwriting or typing. The paper itself is a clean, off-white color.

MY SELF-CARE PLAN

You MUST take care of yourself. This is not optional.

Physical (body):

Sleep: ____hrs Exercise: _____ Eating: _____

Emotional (heart):

Therapy: _____ Journaling: _____ Crying: OK

Social (connection):

Meeting: _____ Friend date: _____

Spiritual (soul):

Prayer: _____ Scripture: _____ Church: _____

Mental (mind):

Reading: _____ Hobby: _____ Limit news/social media

My daily non-negotiable self-care:

Things that are NOT self-care (enabling disguised as caring):

WHEN TO SEEK HELP / CRISIS RESOURCES

SEEK IMMEDIATE HELP IF:

- You are in physical danger
- Your loved one is threatening self-harm or harming others
- Children are being neglected or abused
- You are having thoughts of self-harm
- Substances are in the home with children present

CRISIS RESOURCES:

- 911 (immediate danger)
- SAMHSA Helpline: 1-800-662-4357 (free, 24/7)
- 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline
- National Domestic Violence: 1-800-799-7233
- Al-Anon: al-anon.org / 1-888-425-2666
- Nar-Anon: nar-anon.org

YOU DESERVE HELP WHEN:

- You feel hopeless or trapped
- Your physical health is suffering
- You are unable to function at work/school
- Your other relationships are damaged
- You have lost your sense of self
- You are financially in crisis due to their addiction

Remember: Getting help for YOURSELF is not giving up on them.

It is the bravest, most loving thing you can do.

MILESTONE CELEBRATIONS

YOUR healing matters. Celebrate YOUR milestones:

30 DAYS of MY healing journey:

Date achieved: _____

How I'm different: _____

How I celebrated: _____

90 DAYS of MY healing journey:

Date achieved: _____

Boundaries I've held: _____

Self-care habits established: _____

6 MONTHS of MY healing:

Date achieved: _____

Biggest change in me: _____

What I'm most proud of: _____

1 YEAR of MY healing:

Date achieved: _____

Who I was then vs now: _____

Message to someone just starting this journey:

No matter what they choose, YOU are choosing life.

And that is enough.